

- It also recalls Noah’s “righteous and blameless” moral character (Gen. 6:9 and 7:1).

This entire collection of themes will be developed later in the Hebrew Bible. Righteous Noah’s entrance into the ark becomes an archetype of David’s desire to take refuge in the temple and of the righteous remnant’s longing to enter the temple on the day of Yahweh.

Psalm 15:1-2 NASB*

¹ O LORD, who may abide in your tent?
Who may tabernacle on your holy hill?

² He who walks with **blamelessness** (*tamim*),
and does what is **right** (*tsedeq*),
and speaks truth in his heart.

*Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Psalm 24:1-10 NASB*

¹ The land is Yahweh’s, and all it contains,
the world, and those who dwell in it.

² For he has founded it upon the seas
and established it upon the rivers.

³ Who may ascend into the hill of Yahweh?
And who may stand in his holy place?

⁴ He who has clean hands and a **pure heart**,
who has not lifted up his soul to falsehood
and has not sworn deceitfully.

⁵ He shall receive a blessing from the LORD
and **righteousness** from the God of his salvation.

⁶ This is **the generation** of those who seek him,
who seek your face—even Jacob. Selah.

⁷ Lift up your heads, **O doors**,
and be lifted up, **O ancient doors**,
that the King of glory may come in!

⁸ Who is the King of glory?
Yahweh strong and mighty,
Yahweh mighty in battle.

⁹ Lift up your heads, **O doors**,
and lift them up, **O ancient doors**,
that the King of glory may come in!

¹⁰ Who is this King of glory?
Yahweh of armies,
he is the King of glory. Selah.

*Key Words Adapted by Teacher

"The ark/tabernacle parallels extend beyond their construction to the emphasis placed on the conditionality of their being entered. Leviticus 1:3 states that "unblemished" (*tamim*) animals may be presented at the 'entrance' (*petakh*) of the tent of meeting before Yahweh. As the tabernacle/temple is an architectural cosmic mountain, entrance into the holy of holies symbolizes ascent to the summit of God's holy mountain. The question of 'who shall ascend' in Psalm 15 [and Noah's entrance into the ark] is linked to the Day of Atonement."

Morales, Michael (2012). [*The Tabernacle Pre-Figured: Cosmic Mountain Ideology in Genesis and Exodus*](#). Peeters Publishers. 173.

Isaiah 26:1-4 NASB*

¹ In that day this song will be sung in the land of Judah:

"We have **a strong city**;

he sets up walls and ramparts for security.

² **Open the doors, that the righteous nation may enter,
the one that remains faithful.**

³ The steadfast of mind you will keep in perfect peace,
because he trusts in you.

⁴ Trust in Yahweh forever,
for in God Yahweh, **we have an everlasting rock.**"

*Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Isaiah 26:20-21 NASB*

²⁰ Come, my people, **enter into your rooms**

and close your doors behind you;

hide for a little while

until indignation passes over.

²¹ For behold, Yahweh is about to come out from his place
to punish the iniquity of the inhabitants of the land;

and the land will reveal its shed blood,

and will no longer cover its slain.

*Key Words Adapted by Teacher

For more flood allusions, see [Isaiah 24:5-6](#), [17-20](#); [25:3-10](#)

"[In Isaiah chapters 24-27,] Noah as the righteous world citizen par excellence becomes the leadmotif of those who escape the world judgment; the redemption of the righteous from the primeval flood is the paradigm for the redemption of the righteous from final judgment. It is no longer ethnic membership in Israel, but rather ethical behavior that is the measuring rod of salvation ... At the center of the 'strong city' stands the righteous who may enter through its doors. These are Yahweh worshippers from all nations coming to the temple (thus the allusions to the temple entrance liturgies of [Psalms 15](#) and [24](#)). In the same way that Noah, the exemplary righteous person, goes into the ark (Gen. 7:1-6), so the 'righteous nation' marches into the new Jerusalem ... Just as Yahweh closes the door before the waters (Gen. 7:16), so now his people close the doors behind themselves for a little while."

Reflection Question

To understand the flood story, does it help us to know the cosmology of the biblical authors? If so, how? And what does the flood story have to do with day two of creation in Genesis 1?

Session 16: The Flood Overwhelms the Land

Key Takeaways

- The remnant suffering through chaos in a divinely provided refuge is an image that the biblical authors will use repeatedly to illustrate God's plan of rescue.
- The biblical authors confront feelings of anger, abandonment, and grief. Texts like the Psalms serve as a guide for dealing with negative emotions before God.

The Flood Overwhelms the Land: Translation and Literary Design of Genesis 7:17-24

A 17 And the flood was forty days
upon the land,
and the waters were great (רבה)

B and they lifted up the ark,
and it rose up over the land .

A' 18 And the waters were mighty (גבר) ,
and they were very great (רבה)
upon the land ,

B' and the ark went on the face of the waters .

A 19 And the waters were mighty (גבר) ,
very very much,
upon the land ,

B and they covered all the high mountains which are under the skies,

A' 20 fifteen cubits above,

the waters were mighty (גבר) ,

and they covered the mountains .

21 And all flesh expired ,

what creeps on the land
with the birds
and with the beasts
and with the living creatures,
and with all the swarmers that swarm upon the land,
and all humanity,
22 all that had the inhalation of the breath of life in its nostrils,
from all that was on the dry land,

they died .

23 And he wiped away every standing-thing
that was upon the face of the land,

from humanity
to animals
to creepers
and to birds of the skies,

and they were wiped away from the land;

and only Noah was left remaining,
and those with him in the ark.

24 And the waters were mighty (גבר)
upon the land
one hundred and fifty days .

Genesis 7:17-24. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).